

Uddannelsesmuligheder efter folkeskole



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from New Zealand. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish. What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing your background — it's great that you're thinking carefully about your next steps. In Denmark, finishing primary school (folkeskole) around age 15–16 puts you right at the point where most students choose between different youth education paths. Since you're fluent in Danish and grew up in the Danish school system, you have all the typical options available. Let's walk through them, and I'll suggest what might suit you depending on your interests and goals.

🎓 Main Educational Paths After Folkeskole in Denmark

1. Gymnasium (STX, HHX, HTX) – Academic Upper Secondary Education

Ideal if you're considering university later.

- **STX** (Almen studentereksamen): Broad academic subjects — Danish, English, history, math, science, and humanities.
 - Best if you're still figuring out what you enjoy or want a general education.
- **HHX** (Higher Commercial Exam): Focus on business, economics, and international relations.
 - Great if you're into entrepreneurship, business, or marketing.
- **HTX** (Higher Technical Exam): Focus on technology, science, and IT.
 - Best if you're into computers, biology, chemistry, or engineering.

🟢 *Recommended if:* you enjoy school, want to keep university as an option, and aren't sure exactly what to specialize in yet.

2. EUX or EUD – Vocational Education and Training

These paths lead directly to a trade or profession — but **EUX** also gives you a studentereksamen so you can still go to university later.

- **EUX**: Combines a trade (e.g. electrician, carpenter, health care worker) with academic courses.
 - Takes a bit longer, but keeps many doors open.
- **EUD**: Focused purely on training for a job, with internships and hands-on experience.

🟢 *Recommended if:* you're more practical, want to earn money sooner, and know what kind of job you want (or want to explore trades).

3. International Options / Boarding School / Efterskole

You mentioned your parents are from New Zealand — if you want an international experience:

- **International Baccalaureate (IB):** A globally recognized diploma taught in English. Available at certain gymnasiums in Denmark.
 - Great if you're considering university abroad someday.
- **Efterskole:** A one-year boarding school for 9th or 10th grade. You can focus on a theme — like sports, music, media, design, etc.
 - Ideal for personal growth, social skills, and exploring interests.

 *Recommended if:* you want a break from traditional school structure, want to develop socially, or are curious about studying in English.

How to Decide?

Ask yourself:

- Do I enjoy studying academic subjects? Or do I prefer learning by doing?
- Am I curious about working with people, tech, or business?
- Do I want to go to university someday — in Denmark or abroad?
- Would I like to experience learning in English or travel?

Bonus: If You're Thinking Internationally

Since you have New Zealand roots, you might also consider:

- Doing an **exchange year** in New Zealand or another country.
- Looking at IB programs, which keep your global options open.
- Exploring if you qualify for dual citizenship or educational opportunities through your parents' nationality.

Final Suggestion (based on what you've said)

If you're open to ideas and want to keep both Danish and international options open:

Consider starting at a gymnasium — either STX or IB — unless you have a strong interest in a specific trade.

This keeps the path open for both Danish and international university or career options, and you can specialize more as you go.

Let me know your interests (science, business, music, tech, etc.) or future goals, and I can narrow it down even more!